EV rebound in an electrifying fleet

A diffusion model with heterogeneous ICEV disutility, calibrated to the Dutch BEV fleet

Working draft, 27 October 2026

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Status. This is a working model. The rebound target (10 log points for the 2015 cohort) is a **fictitious placeholder**, to be replaced by register-data estimates per cohort. The levels are illustrative.

1 Question

How does the driving rebound of households that switch from an ICEV to a BEV develop over time as the fleet electrifies?

2 Model

2.1 Driving

The model makes one behavioural assumption about heterogeneity: **households differ in their disutility from driving an ICEV**, for example because of climate concerns. Who switches when, and each cohort's rebound, follow from optimising behaviour and the observed diffusion of BEVs.

A household i owns one car. The perceived cost per km is

$$c_i^I = p_f + \psi_i \quad \text{(ICEV)}, \qquad c^E \quad \text{(EV)},$$

where $\psi_i \geq 0$ is the household's disutility per km driven with an ICEV. This is the heterogeneous primitive. Demand for km has a common elasticity, $v_i(c) = k_i(c/c_i^I)^{-\varepsilon}$, where k_i is the household's km with the ICEV.

The rebound is the log change in km on switching:

$$r_i = \varepsilon \ln \frac{c_i^I}{c^E}.$$

2.2 Adoption

The gain from switching is the present value of the extra surplus from driving, plus the **status** that owning an EV gives. Households value this status differently, $g_i \sim N(0, \sigma_g^2)$. Status is positional: it fades as EVs become common, with weight $\phi(S_{t-1})$ in last year's BEV share. Status affects the decision to switch, but not how much the household drives:

$$G_{it} = A \int_{c^E}^{c_i^I} v_i(c)\, dc + \phi(S_{t-1})\, g_i = A\, \frac{k_i\, c_i^I}{1-\varepsilon} \left[1 - \left(\frac{c^E}{c_i^I} \right)^{1-\varepsilon} \right] + \phi(S_{t-1})\, g_i, \qquad \phi(S) = 0.5^{\,S/\bar{S}}.$$

Here:

- A is an annuity factor over 8 years at 4%;
- status halves with every $\bar{S} = 10$ percentage points of BEV share.

A household can only switch when it replaces its car, which it does with probability $\lambda = 0.12$ per year. It then switches if $G_{it} \geq F_t$. The net EV premium F_t declines smoothly, and is lowered by the SEPP purchase subsidy (2020–2024) with pass-through ω. The pass-through is below one because SEPP was budget-capped and only for private buyers:

$$F_t = F_\infty + (F_0 - F_\infty)\, e^{-\gamma(t-2016)} - \omega\, \mathrm{SEPP}_t.$$

As status fades, the driving gain weighs more in the decision, which sharpens selection on ψ in later cohorts. Up to 2026 the effect is small, because the BEV share stays below 10%.

2.3 What the model implies for rebound over time

Both the gain and the rebound rise in ψ_i:

$$\frac{\partial G_i}{\partial \psi_i} = A\, v_i(c_i^I) > 0, \qquad \frac{\partial r_i}{\partial \psi_i} = \frac{\varepsilon}{c_i^I} > 0.$$

Households with a high ICEV disutility therefore switch earlier *and* rebound more. As F_t falls, adoption moves to households with a lower ψ, and the cohort rebound declines.

How strong this is depends on how much of the variation in G comes from ψ rather than from k and g. Those two shift adoption but not the rebound. With a homogeneous ψ, or with adoption timing unrelated to type, rebound is the same for every cohort.

2.4 Assumptions

Parameter	Value	Basis
fuel cost p_f	€0.12/km	6.5 l/100 km at €1.85/l
EV cost c^E	€0.06/km	mix of home and public charging, about €0.35/kWh
ICEV disutility ψ	lognormal, mean €0.02/km, sdlog **estimated**	mean: about €130/tCO_2 at 0.15 kg/km
km k	lognormal, mean 13,000, sdlog 0.55	CBS: about 12,300 km
elasticity ε	common, **estimated**	

Parameter	Value	Basis
status sd σ_g	**estimated**	
status halving share $\bar{S}$	10% BEV share	assumption
SEPP subsidy	€4,000 (2020–21), €3,350 (2022), €2,950 (2023–24)	RVO
premium path F_0, F_∞, γ, SEPP pass-through ω	**estimated**	
replacement rate λ	0.12	

All type components are drawn independently.

3 Calibration

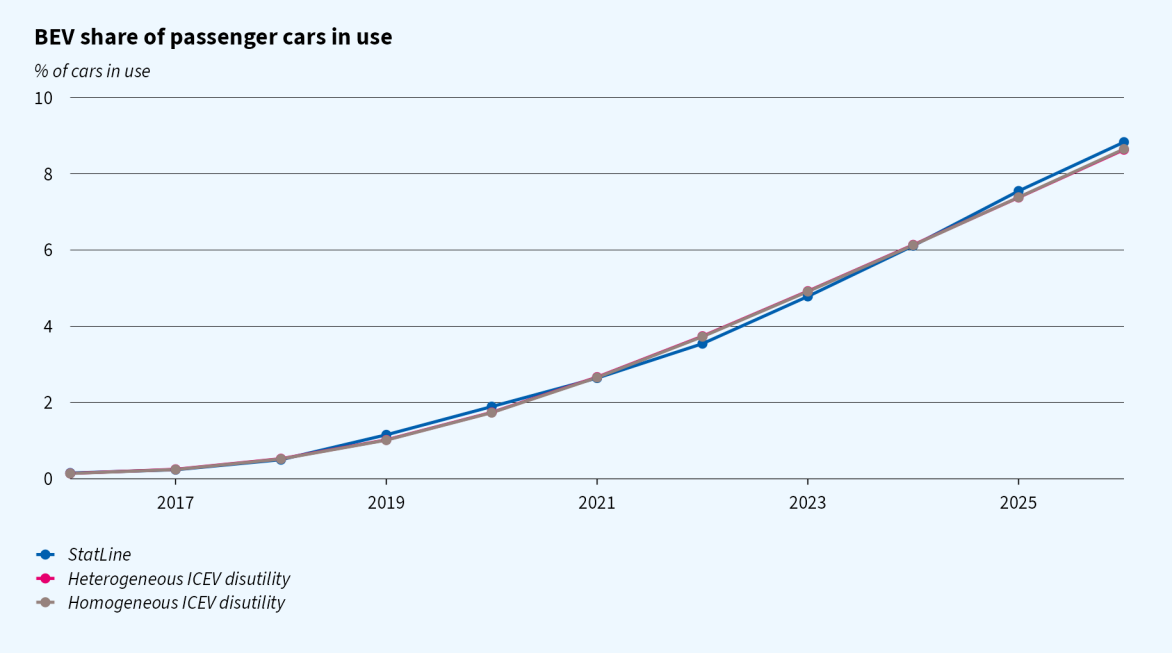
The parameters are estimated by simulated method of moments. Because the premium path is restricted to a smooth decline plus the known SEPP subsidy, the model no longer matches the BEV share by construction. The shape of the S-curve, and the response to the subsidy, then inform how dispersed the adoption gain is.

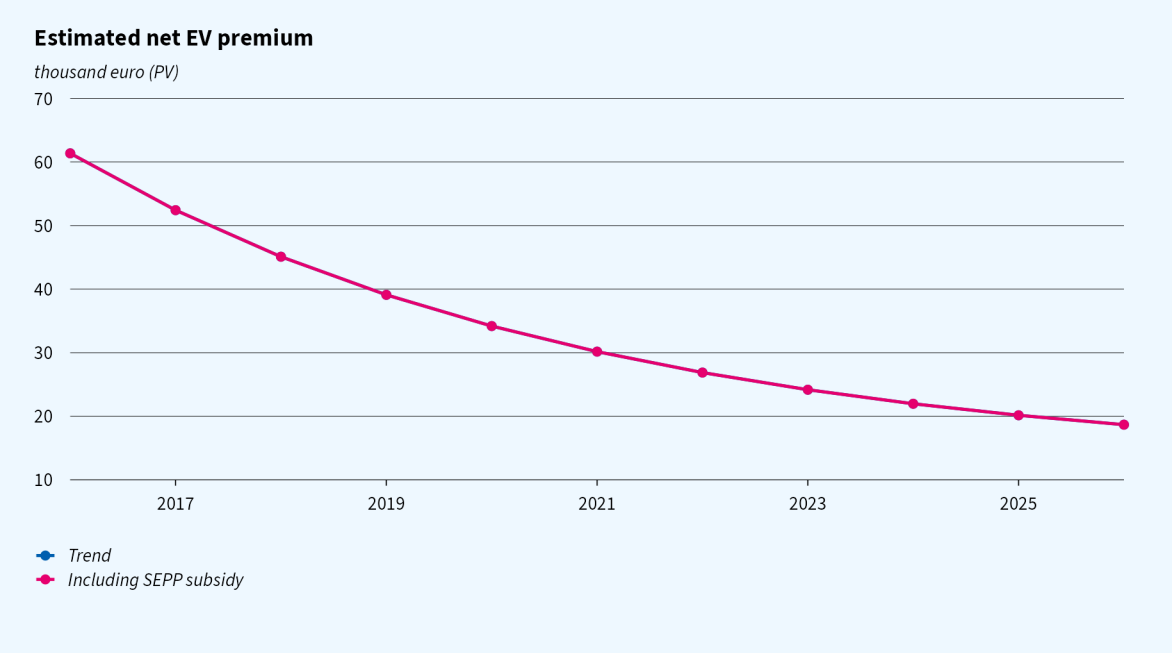
Moment	Source
BEV share of cars in use, 2016–2026 (relative deviations)	StatLine 83703NED, 85405NED; 2025–2026 extended with new BEV sales (85898NED)
rebound of the 2015 cohort (all adopters up to 2015) = 10 log points	**placeholder**
km of BEVs / all cars in use, 2024 = 1.47	StatLine 85405NED

Estimated parameter	Heterogeneous ψ	Homogeneous ψ
elasticity ε	0.101	0.118
status sd σ_g	€18,778	€19,709
ICEV disutility sdlog	0.84	0 (fixed)
premium F_0 / F_∞	€61,365 / €11,970	€63,210 / €11,752
premium decline γ	0.200	0.195
SEPP pass-through ω	0.00	0.00
loss (sum of squared deviations)	0.0404	0.0350

The BEV share uses the 'full elektrisch' category. The fuel type 'Elektriciteit' in the fleet tables includes hybrids.

In the simulation, the threshold rule is smoothed: a household that replaces its car adopts with probability $\Lambda((G_{it} - F_t)/\tau)$, with τ = €1,000. This keeps all moments continuous in the parameters. The estimation runs on 250,000 simulated households; the results below use 1,000,000.





Three findings from the estimation:

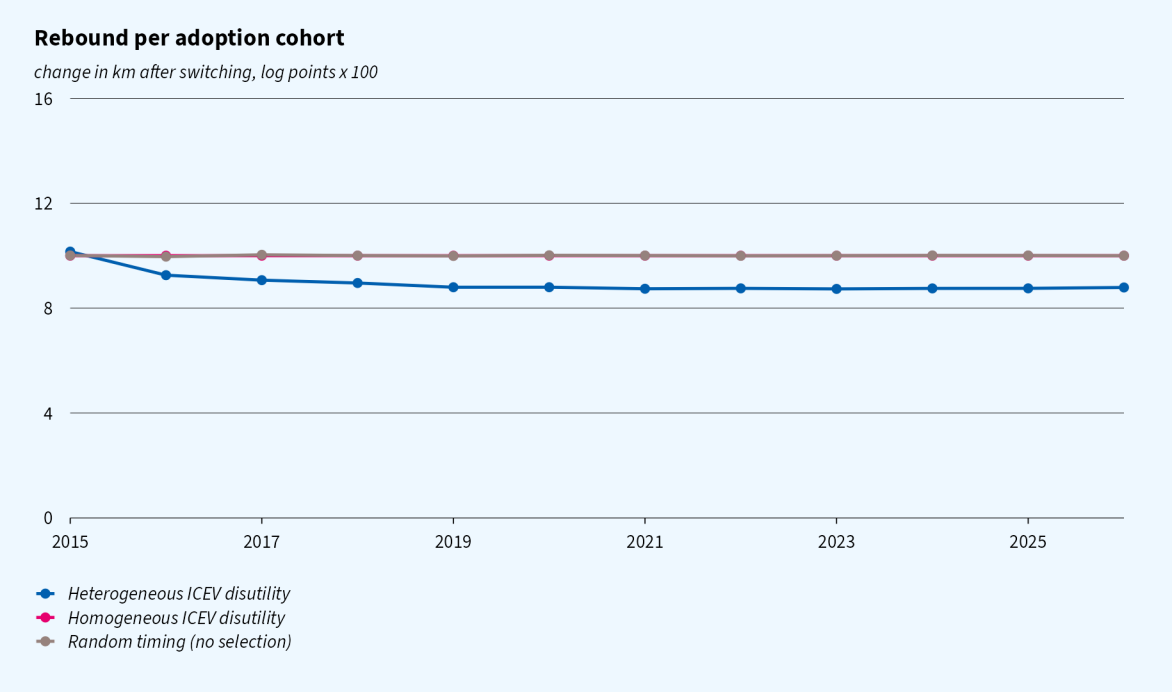
- **The share path is fitted well** with a premium that falls from about €61k in 2016 towards €12k.
- **The SEPP pass-through is estimated at zero.** The share path shows no visible jump when the subsidy started (2020) or stopped (2025).
- **The share path does not tell the two models apart.** The heterogeneous and the homogeneous ICEV disutility fit about equally well (losses 0.040 and 0.035 on the full population; the small difference is simulation noise). So the estimated spread of ψ (sdlog 0.84) is only weakly identified. The rebound per cohort from register data is what will discipline it.

4 Results

4.1 Rebound over time

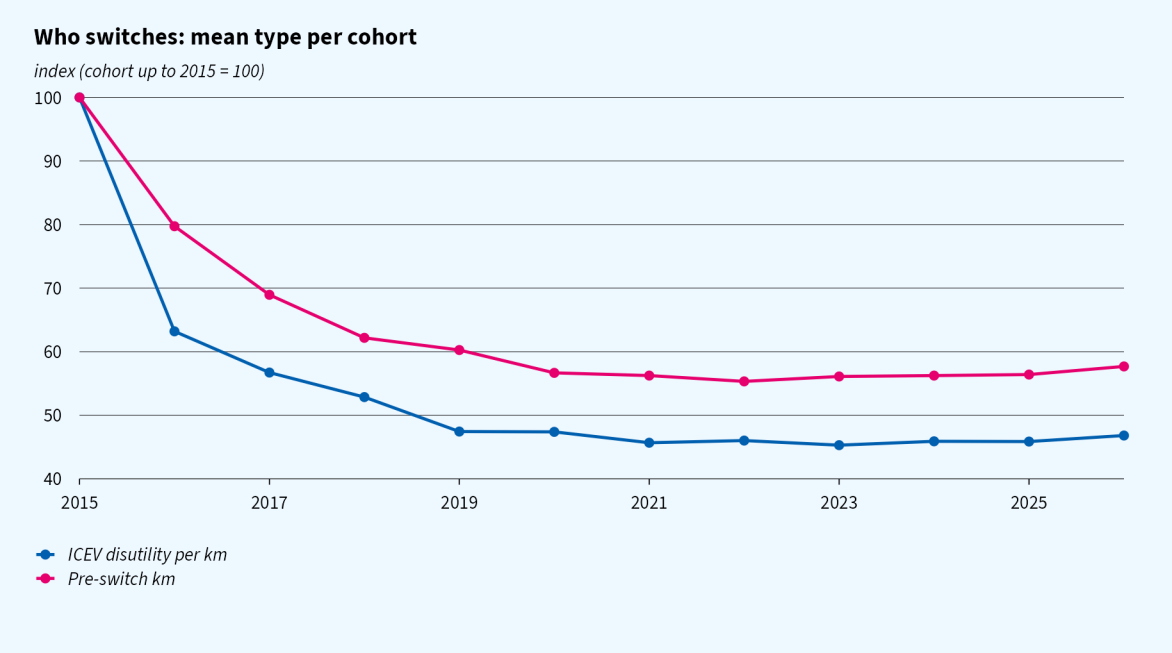
With a heterogeneous ICEV disutility, the cohort rebound falls from 10.2 log points (adopters up to 2015) to 8.8 (2026). Most of the decline happens before the BEV share reaches about 1% (2019). After that, the profile is nearly flat.

With a homogeneous disutility, or with random timing, the rebound is constant. Each scenario is recalibrated to the same 2015 target.

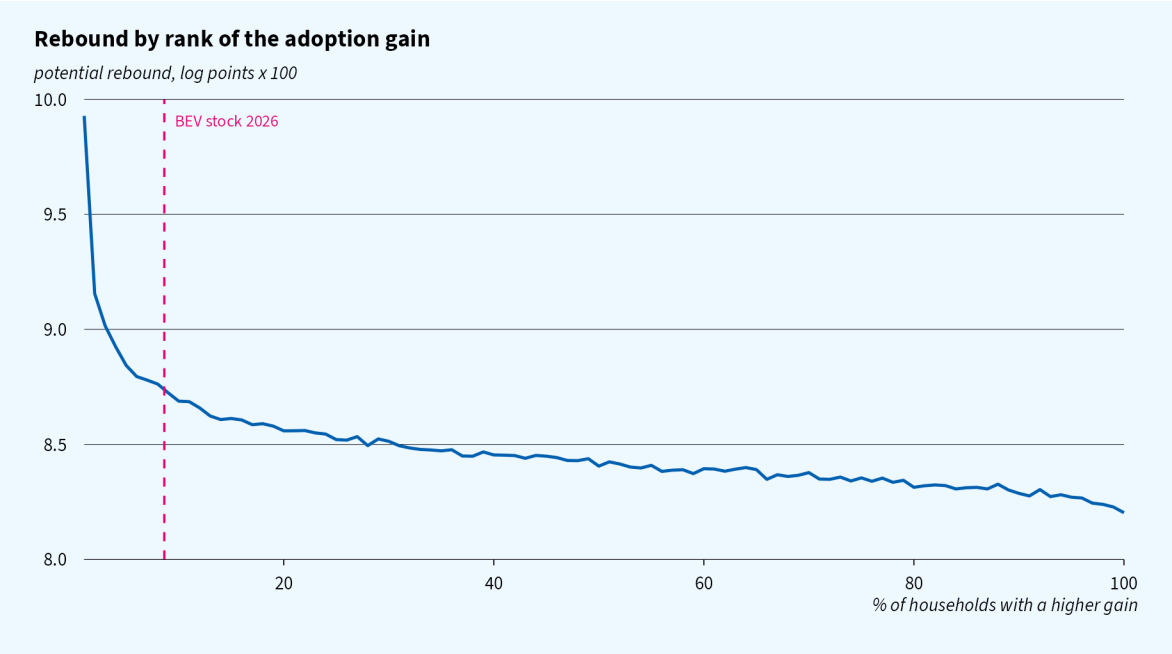


4.2 Who switches

Early cohorts have a high ICEV disutility and drive a lot. Both fall as the fleet electrifies.



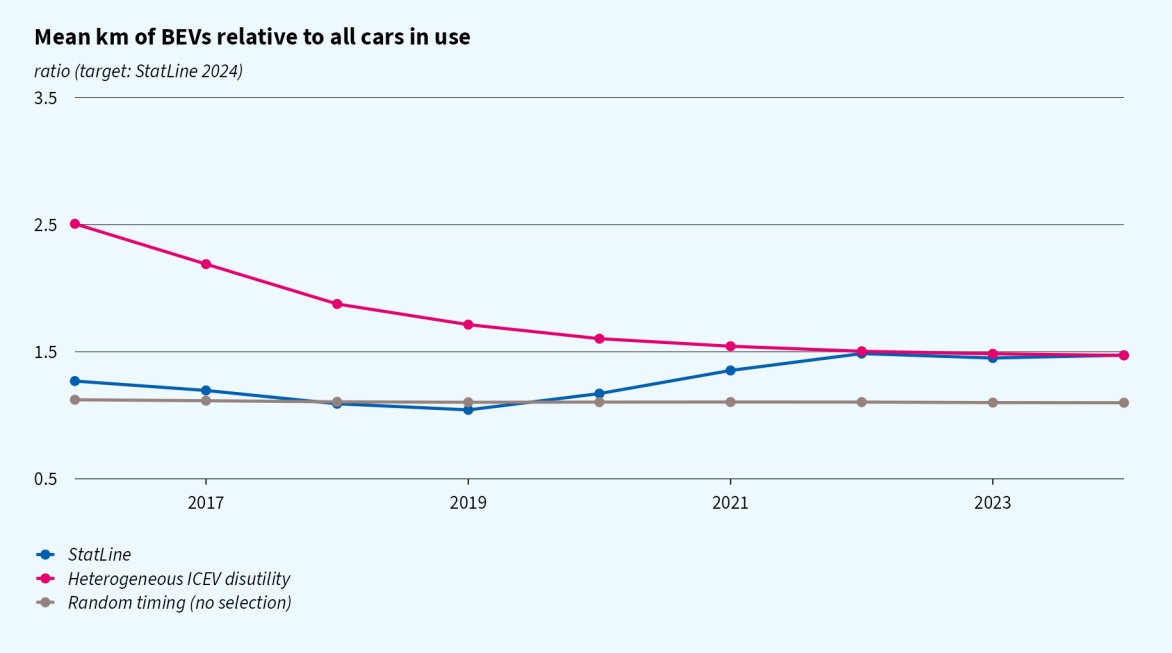
The figure below shows the rebound each household would have if it switched, ordered by its gain. The remaining ICEV owners would rebound somewhat less than the first adopters, but the curve is flat over most of the population.



4.3 Untargeted check: km of BEVs over time

The model matches the 2024 ratio. In earlier years, it has BEVs driven far more than the average car, while StatLine shows a modest ratio that rises over time. This points to constraints the model leaves out:

- the limited range of early BEVs;
- company cars.



5 Next steps

1. Target the full **rebound profile per cohort** from register data. Whether, and how steeply, it declines identifies how dispersed the ICEV disutility is.
2. Add a **range constraint** that loosens over time, and a **company car segment**.
3. Separate **cohort, period and duration effects**, using ICEV-to-ICEV replacers as controls.
4. Compute the **rebound of the remaining ICEV owners** under a phase-out.

Code: `R/`. Specification: `docs/model.md`. Figures: ggcpb, open source fallback font.